

CO1 - IT3

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course: Ethical hacking

Course code: ITA1407

If you're asked to perform a "red team" exercise versus a "vulnerability assessment" using a real-world scenario of a bank wanting to test physical and digital security, explain how your approach, ethics, and rules of engagement would differ between the two.

A bank wants to evaluate both its physical and digital security.

vulnerability assessment

* The main goal is to identify and report security weakness in the bank's systems.

* servers, application, networks & configuration are scanned to find vulnerabilities

* vulnerabilities are identified but not fully exploited to avoid causing damage.

* All testing is performed only within the agreed scope and with proper authorization.

* The findings are documented with risk levels and recommendations to improve security

Red - Team Exercise

*> The main goal is to simulate a real cyberattack on the bank's systems.

*> The test includes phishing, social engineering, and physical security checks when authorized.

*> It controlled exploitation is used to evaluate the bank's detection and response capabilities.

*> The exercise follows strict rules of engagement, including scope, objectives and safety measures.

*> sensitive data is protected, unnecessary damage is avoided, and all critical findings are reported.

Difference between the two

Vulnerability Assessment	Red Team Exercise
i) Finds & reports vulnerability	simulates a real attacker
ii) Limited or no exploitation	controlled exploitation is allowed.
iii) Focuses on Identifying weaknesses	Focuses on testing detection and response.
iv) Lower risk to operations	higher risks so stricter controls are required.
v) produces a list of security issues	Demonstrates the real-world impact of an attack.

conclusion

A vulnerability assessment helps the bank discover and fix security weaknesses, while a red team exercise evaluates whether the bank people, process and technology can successfully detect and respond to a realistic cyberattack. Both require proper authorization, ethical conduct, and clearly defined rules of engagement.